

Spatial Economics - TA Session 2

Model Estimation and Counterfactuals with Caliendo et al. (2018)

Berkay Saygin¹

¹University of Chicago

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Framework Recap

Consider an economy with

- parameters $\Sigma = \{\sigma, \alpha, \{d_{ni}\}_{i \in N, n \in N}\}$
- (exogenous) fundamentals $A = \{A_i, H_i\}_{i \in N}$
- (endogenous) allocations $Y = \{L_i\}_{i \in N}$
- (endogenous) prices $P = \{w_i\}_{i \in N}$
- agents' optimality conditions and market clearing $F(\Sigma, A, Y, P) = 0$
- equilibrium defined as:

Competitive Equilibrium (CE)

Given parameters and fundamentals $\{\Sigma, A\}$, a CE is a set of prices and allocations $\{P, Y\}$ such that given prices P , allocations Y solve $F(\Sigma, A, Y, P) = 0$.

Framework Recap

- Solving the model: characterize endogenous Y, P as a function of fundamentals

$$\Sigma + A \xrightarrow{F} Y, P$$

- Calibration: find Σ that is established by the literature or matches model implied moments

$$\underbrace{Y, P}_{\text{observed}} \xrightarrow{F} \underbrace{\Sigma}_{\text{estimated}}$$

- Inversion: find A that rationalizes data under the assumptions of the model and Σ

$$\Sigma + \underbrace{Y, P}_{\text{observed}} \xrightarrow{F} \underbrace{A}_{\text{estimated/inverted}}$$

- Counterfactuals:** ask how changes in exogenous objects would change the outcome

$$\underbrace{\hat{\Sigma} + \hat{A}}_{\text{assumed changes}} \xrightarrow{F} \underbrace{\hat{Y}, \hat{P}}_{\text{object of interest}}$$

Regional $\times$ Sectoral Trade and Migration Model (Caliendo et al., 2018)

Question: How do elasticities of TFP, GDP, employment with respect to regional/sectoral productivity changes differ at aggregate, regional, sectoral, regional $\times$ sectoral level?

- Model with 50 US States n , 26 sectors j , labor L_n^j and land H_n^j as factors
- Labor is mobile across regions and sectors, land is mobile across sectors
- In each j , intermediate varieties $u^j \in [0, 1]^j$ produced by representative firms $\{u_n^j\}_n$
 - For each u^j , each firm u_n^j draws idiosyncratic productivity z_n^j
 - $\{u_n^j\}_n$ compete to sell variety u^j to final good- j aggregators Q_n^j across n
 - Only u_n^j with the lowest MC (incl. trade cost κ_{mn}) among $\{u_n^j\}_n$ sell u^j to Q_m^j
- Final good- j aggregators produce Q_n^j by aggregating varieties $u^j \in [0, 1]^j$, ensuring each u^j is supplied from the cheapest among $\{u_n^j\}_n$

Intermediate Firms - Allocations (Caliendo et al., 2018)

Choose a j , and choose a $u^j \in [0, 1]^j$. Producer of u^j in n has:

$$q_n^j(z_n^j) = z_n^j \left[T_n^j [h_n^j(z_n^j)]^{\beta_n} [\ell_n^j(z_n^j)]^{(1-\beta_n)} \right]^{\gamma_n^j} \prod_{k=1}^J \left[M_n^{jk}(z_n^j) \right]^{\gamma_n^{jk}}$$

- z_n^j : u_n^j 's productivity draw where $\Pr(z_n^j \leq z) = F_n^j(z) = e^{-z^{-\theta^j}}$
- $q_n^j(z_n^j)$: production technology of u_n^j with z_n^j
- T_n^j : fundamental productivity, common to all intermediate firms in n, j
- $h_n^j(z_n^j)$: input use of land by i with z_n^j
- $\ell_n^j(z_n^j)$: input use of labor by i with z_n^j
- $M_n^{jk}(z_n^j)$: input use of final good (locally) produced by sector k by i with z_n^j

Intermediate Firms - Parameters (Caliendo et al., 2018)

$$\underbrace{q_n^j(z_n^j)}_{\text{output}} = \underbrace{z_n^j \left[T_n^j [h_n^j(z_n^j)]^{\beta_n} [\mu_n^j(z_n^j)]^{(1-\beta_n)} \right]^{\gamma_n^j}}_{\text{value added (sums to GDP)}} \underbrace{\prod_{k=1}^J [M_n^{jk}(z_n^j)]^{\gamma_n^{jk}}}_{\text{inputs}}$$

- β_n : share of land/structures in value added (from BEA, GDP by state)
- γ_n^j : share of value added in output for n, j (from BEA, input output (io) tables)
- γ_n^{jk} : input share of sector k in output of sector j produced in n (from BEA, io tables)
- θ^j : Frechet shape, also elasticity of trade to trade cost (from Caliendo and Parro (2015))

In replication package, θ^j is $1/T$, β_n is B . T_n^j are not calculated since model is not inverted.

Intermediate Firms - Price (Caliendo et al., 2018)

- Fix a variety u^j . Producer u_n^j has the marginal cost given by

$$\frac{x_n^j}{z_n^j (T_n^j)^{\gamma_n^j}} \quad \text{where} \quad x_n^j = B_n^j \left[r_n^{\beta_n} w_n^{1-\beta_n} \right]^{\gamma_n^j} \prod_{k=1}^J \left[P_n^k \right]^{\gamma_n^{jk}}$$

$$\text{and } B_n^j = \left[\gamma_n^j (1 - \beta_n)^{(1-\beta_n)} \beta_n^{\beta_n} \right]^{-\gamma_n^j} \prod_{k=1}^J \left[\gamma_n^{jk} \right]^{-\gamma_n^{jk}}$$

- Then, price of u_n^j , when sold to country m is $\frac{\kappa_{mn}^j x_n^j}{z_n^j (T_n^j)^{\gamma_n^j}}$
- And, price of u^j , in country m is $\min_{n \in \{1, \dots, N\}} \frac{\kappa_{mn}^j x_n^j}{z_n^j (T_n^j)^{\gamma_n^j}}$

Final Good Firms (Caliendo et al., 2018)

- A final good firm in each n, j aggregates across varieties $u^j \in [0, 1]^j$

$$Q_n^j = \left[\int_0^1 \tilde{q}_n^j (u^j)^{1-1/\eta_n^j} du^j \right]^{\eta_n^j / (\eta_n^j - 1)}$$

- Change of variables to instead integrate across vectors of $z^j = [z_1^j, \dots, z_N^j]$
- $\tilde{q}_n^j (z^j)^{1-1/\eta_n^j}$ is weighted by how many varieties u^j exist with that z^j

$$Q_n^j = \left[\int \cdots \int \tilde{q}_n^j (z^j)^{1-1/\eta_n^j} \phi^j (z^j) dz_1^j \cdots dz_N^j \right]^{\eta_n^j / (\eta_n^j - 1)}$$

- with ideal price index $P_n^j = \left[\int p_n^j (z^j)^{1-\eta_n^j} \phi^j (z^j) dz^j \right]^{1/(1-\eta_n^j)}$

Derivation From (Eaton and Kortum, 2002)

Use price index, unit cost, and Frechet trick.

$$\begin{aligned} P_n^j &= \left[\int p_n^j(z^j)^{1-\eta_n^j} \phi^j(z^j) dz^j \right]^{1/(1-\eta_n^j)} \\ &= \left[\int \left(\min_i \left\{ \left(\kappa_{ni}^j x_i^j \right) / \left(z_i^j (T_i^j)^{\gamma_i^j} \right) \right\} \right)^{1-\eta_n^j} \phi^j(z^j) dz^j \right]^{1/(1-\eta_n^j)} \\ &= \dots \\ &= \Gamma(\zeta_n^j)^{\frac{1}{1-\eta_n^j}} \left[\sum_{i=1}^N \left[x_i^j \kappa_{ni}^j \right]^{-\theta^j} \left(T_i^j \right)^{\theta^j \gamma_i^j} \right]^{-\frac{1}{\theta^j}} \quad \text{if } j \text{ tradable} \\ &\quad \Gamma(\zeta_n^j)^{\frac{1}{1-\eta_n^j}} x_n^j (T_n^j)^{-\gamma_n^j} \quad \text{otherwise} \end{aligned}$$

where $\Gamma(\zeta_n^j)$ is the Gamma function evaluated at $\zeta_n^j = 1 + (1 - \eta_n^j) / \theta^j$.

Expenditure Shares (Eaton and Kortum, 2002)

$$\underbrace{X_{ni}^j}_{n\text{'s expenditure on } j, n} = \Pr \left[p_{ni}^j(z^j) \leq \min_{m \neq i} \{ p_{nm}^j(z^j) \} \right] \underbrace{X_n^j}_{n\text{'s expenditure on } j}$$

$$\underbrace{\pi_{ni}^j}_{\text{bilateral trade shares}} \equiv \frac{X_{ni}^j}{X_n^j} = \left[\frac{\kappa_{ni}^j x_i^j \Gamma \left(\zeta_n^j \right)^{\frac{1}{1-\eta_n^j}}}{\left(T_i^j \right)^{\gamma_i^j} P_n^j} \right]^{-\theta^j} = \frac{\left[x_i^j \kappa_{ni}^j \right]^{-\theta^j} T_i^{j\theta^j \gamma_i^j}}{\sum_{m=1}^N \left[x_m^j \kappa_{nm}^j \right]^{-\theta^j} T_m^{j\theta^j \gamma_m^j}}$$

In package, $X_{ni}^j, X_n^j, \pi_{ni}^j$ come from Commodity Flow Survey, X_{ni}^j is xbilat, π_{ni}^j is Din

Consumers

- Household in n has preferences $U(C_n) = \prod_{j=1}^J (c_n^j)^{\alpha^j}$ where $\sum_{j=1}^J \alpha^j = 1$
- Ideal price index is $P_n = \prod_{j=1}^J (P_n^j / \alpha^j)^{\alpha^j}$
- Income is location specific

$$I_n = \underbrace{w_n}_{\text{labor income}} + \underbrace{\chi}_{\text{US portfolio income}} + \underbrace{(1 - \iota_n) r_n H_n / L_n}_{\text{local rent income}}$$

where $\chi = \sum_{i=1}^N \iota_i r_i H_i / \sum_{i=1}^N L_i$

L_n comes from BEA.

α^j 's are calculated for aggregate US using GDP, imports, and exports in each sector.

Consumers

- Model allows trade imbalances. Let $Y_n \equiv \iota_n r_n H_n - \chi L_n$.
 - If $Y_n > 0$, n sends money out, so n gives trade surplus
 - Let Y_n^{data} denote trade surplus implied by data on X_{ni}^j
 - Model implied ι_n are then estimated to minimize $|Y_n - Y_n^{data}|$
- By free market mobility

$$L_n = \frac{\left(\frac{\omega_n}{UP_n}\right)^{\frac{1}{\beta_n}} H_n}{\sum_{i=1}^N \left(\frac{\omega_i}{UP_i}\right)^{\frac{1}{\beta_i}} H_i} L$$

where $\omega_n \equiv \left(\frac{w_n}{1-\beta_n}\right)^{1-\beta_n} \left(\frac{r_n}{\beta_n}\right)^{\beta_n}$ is the unobserved local composite factor price

I_n are calculated as $I_n = VA_n^{data} / L_n - Y_n / L_n$ where VA_n^{data} , value added, comes from BEA.

Other Equilibrium Conditions (Check the paper on how to take care of S_n)

- Regional Market Clearing

$$X_n^j = \sum_k \gamma_n^{kj} \sum_i \pi_{in}^k X_i^k + \alpha^j \left(\omega_n (H_n)^{\beta_n} (L_n)^{1-\beta_n} - Y_n - S_n \right)$$

- and Trade Balance

$$\sum_{j=1}^J X_n^j + Y_n + S_n = \sum_{j=1}^J \sum_{i=1}^N \pi_{in}^j X_i^j$$

- imply

$$\omega_n (H_n)^{\beta_n} (L_n)^{1-\beta_n} = \sum_j \gamma_n^j \sum_{i=1}^N \pi_{in}^j X_i^j$$

$$\hat{x}_n^j = (\hat{\omega}_n)^{\gamma_n^j} \prod_{k=1}^J \left(\hat{\rho}_n^k \right)^{\gamma_n^{jk}} \quad (1)$$

$$\hat{\rho}_n^j = \left(\sum_{i=1}^N \pi_{ni}^j \left[\hat{\kappa}_{ni}^j \hat{x}_i^j \right]^{-\theta^j} \hat{\tau}_i^{j\theta^j} \gamma_i^j \right)^{-1/\theta^j} \quad (2)$$

$$\pi_{ni}^{j'} = \pi_{ni}^j \left(\frac{\hat{x}_i^j}{\hat{\rho}_n^j} \hat{\kappa}_{ni}^j \right)^{-\theta^j} \hat{\tau}_i^{j\theta^j} \gamma_i^j \quad (3)$$

$$\hat{L}_n = \frac{\left(\frac{\hat{\omega}_n}{\varphi_n \hat{P}_n \hat{U} + (1 - \varphi_n) \hat{b}_n} \right)^{1/\beta_n}}{\sum_i L_i \left(\frac{\hat{\omega}_i}{\varphi_i \hat{P}_i \hat{U} + (1 - \varphi_i) \hat{b}_i} \right)^{1/\beta_i}} L \quad (4)$$

$$X_n^{j'} = \sum_{k=1}^J \gamma_n^{k,j} \left(\sum_{i=1}^N \pi_{in}^{k'} X_i^{k'} \right) + a^j \left(\hat{\omega}_n (\hat{L}_n)^{1-\beta_n} (I_n L_n + Y_n + S_n) - S'_n - Y'_n \right) \quad (5)$$

$$\hat{\omega}_n (\hat{L}_n)^{1-\beta_n} (L_n I_n + Y_n + S_n) = \sum_j \gamma_n^j \sum_i \pi_{in}^{j'} X_i^{j'} \quad (6)$$

Roadmap - “Solving” the baseline equilibrium

- Solving the model in levels requires knowing fundamentals: T_i^j, κ_{ni}^j
- Authors don't invert the model
- Express the equilibrium in changes and there should be no changes in steady state

$$\underbrace{\theta^j, \alpha^j, \beta_n, \gamma_n^j, \gamma_n^{jk}}_{\text{calibration}} + \underbrace{I_n, L_n, Y_n, \pi_{ni}^j}_{\text{data}} \xrightarrow{\hat{F}} \underbrace{\tilde{I}_n, \tilde{L}_n, \tilde{Y}_n, \tilde{\pi}_{ni}^j}_{\text{baseline allocations}} \xrightarrow{\hat{F}} \underbrace{\hat{I}_n, \hat{L}_n, \hat{Y}_n, \hat{\pi}_{ni}^j}_{\text{counterfactual equilibrium}}$$

- *CPRHS_Benchmark.m* solves model-consistent baseline allocations that fix residuals associated with trade imbalances and ι_n 's
- *Shock_California_Computers.m* (many alternatives) solves for counterfactual equilibrium

Why We Need Baseline Allocations?

- $\iota_n = \arg \max |Y_n - Y_n^{data}|$ subject to $\iota \in [0, 1]$ does not fit the data, and lead to a residual surplus $S_n \neq 0$
- Baseline equilibrium solves for changes needed to achieve $S'_n = 0$
- Changes are small since S_n is close to 0
- This produces a new equilibrium allocation that is computed using data, but adjusted so that it is model consistent
- Counterfactuals are then computed using these allocations

Sketch of the Algorithm for Solving the Equilibrium Allocations

- Assume changes in fundamentals $\hat{\kappa}_{ni}^j, \hat{H}_n, \hat{T}_{ni}^j$
- Guess changes in the composite factor price $\hat{\omega}_n^{(0)}$
- While $\hat{\omega}_n^{(l)} - \hat{\omega}_n^{(l-1)} > \text{tol}$
 - Compute $\hat{P}_n^{j(l)}, \hat{x}_n^{j(l)}$ using (1) and (2)
 - Compute $\pi_{ni}^{j'}(\hat{\omega})$ using (3)
 - Compute $\hat{L}_n(\hat{\omega})$ using (4)
 - Compute $X_n^{j'}(\hat{\omega})$ using (5)
 - Compute $\hat{\omega}_n^{(l+1)}$ using (6) and update $l = l + 1$
- Note that authors update $\hat{\omega}_n^{(l)}$ partially, i.e. $\hat{\omega}_n^{(l+1)} = \delta \hat{\omega}_n^{(l)} + (1 - \delta) \hat{\omega}_n^{(new)}$ for $\delta \in (0, 1)$

Download the replication package which includes the code used in this TA session at:

<https://sites.google.com/site/lorenzocaliendo/research/CPRHS>

References I

- Caliendo, Lorenzo and Fernando Parro**, “Estimates of the Trade and Welfare Effects of NAFTA,” *The Review of Economic Studies*, 2015, 82 (1), 1–44.
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